FAMILY AND FRIENDS 3 · GRAMMAR EXPLAINED

Present simple or present continuous?

Name _____

THE BIG IDEA

Ask one question: «Is it a habit or is it happening now?» A habit → present simple. Happening now → present continuous.

Задай один вопрос: «Это привычка или происходит сейчас?» Привычка — present simple. Сейчас — present continuous.

How we build it

WHICH	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	РУССКИЙ
Present simple	subject · verb(-s)	**I swim every day. He swims every day.**	Я плаваю каждый день.
Present continuous	subject · am / is / are · verb-ing	**I'm swimming now. He's swimming now.**	Я плаваю сейчас.
Simple: signals	every day · always · usually · on Mondays	**She usually walks to school.**	Она обычно ходит пешком.
Continuous: signals	now · right now · at the moment · Look! · Listen!	**Look! She's walking!**	Смотри! Она идёт!
Simple: no / ?	don't / doesn't · Do / Does …?	**Does he swim every day?**	
Continuous: no / ?	isn't / aren't · Is / Are …?	**Is he swimming now?**	

When we use it

Habits, facts, timetables → present simple
Привычки, факты, расписание.

Happening now, or around now → present continuous
Происходит сейчас.

Both together: I usually walk to school, but today I'm taking the bus.
Обычно и сегодня.

REMEMBER

Time words decide: every day / always / usually → present simple · now / right now / at the moment / Look! → present continuous.

RUSSIAN AND ENGLISH

По-русски одна форма: «Я плаваю» (всегда и сейчас). По-английски две: I swim (всегда) и I'm swimming (сейчас). Спроси себя: «Всегда или сейчас?»

Watch out! We often say…

~~I am swimming every day.~~	**I swim every day.**
~~I swim now.~~	**I'm swimming now.**
~~He is play.~~	**He plays. / He's playing.**
~~What do you do now?~~	**What are you doing now?**

EASY TRICK

Present simple = ONE word (swims). Present continuous = TWO words (is swimming). Look at the time word first!

Try it! Circle the right answer

1 I ___ to school every day. (walk / am walking)

2 Look! He ___. (swims / is swimming)

3 She ___ breakfast at 7. (has / is having)

4 Listen! They ___. (sing / are singing)

5 What ___ you doing now? (are / do)

6 I ___ like fishing. (don't / am not)

7 He ___ TV at the moment. (watches / is watching)

8 We ___ soccer on Saturdays. (play / are playing)

Answers: 1 walk · 2 is swimming · 3 has · 4 are singing · 5 are · 6 don't · 7 is watching · 8 play